



The Honourable Senator Rubio
2025
California State Senate
1021 O Street
Sacramento, CA 95814

November 20th,

Dear Senator Rubio,

On behalf of the League of California Cities, we are pleased to express our support for SB 18, the Safety Data Public Access Act. This legislation represents an important advancement in strengthening public trust, improving transparency in local public safety operations, and supporting cities as they continue their long standing commitment to open and accountable governance.

Cities across California understand that accessible and clearly presented public safety information is essential to fostering strong relationships between law enforcement agencies and the communities they serve. SB 18 advances this goal by requiring agencies to publish annual reports summarizing existing data on emergency response times, use-of-force incidents, and community complaints, while ensuring that this information is presented in a format that is understandable, accessible, and reflective of each community's unique needs.

The League greatly appreciates that SB 18 respects local authority and operational flexibility. The bill's amendments, particularly those clarifying that agencies must report only data already collected in the normal course of operations and those allowing cities to use their own reporting formats, ensure that the measure enhances transparency without imposing unfunded mandates or creating new administrative burdens for municipalities of varying sizes and capacities. Additionally, the strengthened privacy protections and de-identification requirements appropriately safeguard both residents and public safety personnel.

We further commend the bill's shift toward supportive rather than punitive compliance measures. By replacing prescriptive enforcement mechanisms with technical assistance, expanded deadline flexibility, and optional template formats developed by the Attorney General, SB 18 recognizes the differing resources available to local agencies and promotes a collaborative statewide effort to improve public access to safety information. This balanced approach aligns with the League's core principle that transparency is most effective when paired with thoughtful implementation and respect for local governance.

For these reasons, the League of California Cities is pleased to support SB 18 and respectfully urges its passage. We appreciate your leadership on strengthening public trust in government and look forward to continued collaboration on policies that enhance transparency, accountability, and community engagement throughout California.

Sincerely,
Cal Sanchez
League of California Cities